

BRANCH PLANT

[Inspired by John's memo on digital sovereignty]

fiddle intro *full band*

Lyrics by Ajay Agrawal, Chart by Tom Benke ©2026

||D ///| ///G A |D ///| ///| ||D ///|G /D /G /D /A ///...

[Verse 1]

Well we built our towns on timber, And we stitched the rails with steel,
Sent our wheat across the water, Put our kids behind the wheel.
Now the backbone's made of servers, Satel-lites and copper veins,
And the landlord's got a login To the snow the banks the plains.

[Pre-Chorus]

So raise a glass in Ottawa, From Yellowknife to Saint John,
Are we wiring up tomorrow Or just renting till it's gone?

[Chorus]

I don't wanna be a branch plant folks, Don't wanna lease my name.
Don't wanna sell the northern lights And rent them back in shame
Give me compute, give me data, Give me sky that we command
I don't wanna be a branch plant folks, I wanna build this land.

[Verse 2]

There's a cloud across the border, And it knows our every file,
There's a dish upon the farmhouse With a foreign country smile.
And the Arctic keeps on callin' Through the static and the storm,
Sayin' "Sovereignty's not speeches friends It's who keeps the signal warm."

[Pre-Chorus]

So pass the word through kitchen doors Through labs and union halls:
If the future's on a platform Then we'd better own the walls.

[Chorus]

I don't wanna be a branch plant folks, Don't wanna lease my name.
Don't wanna sell the northern lights And rent them back in shame
Give me compute, give me data, Give me sky that we command
I don't wanna be a branch plant folks, I wanna build this land. (hey!)

[Bridge]

Bm _____ D _____
 Put the photons down in Ottawa, Put the satellites up in_ the sky,
 Bm _____ D _____ A _____
 Put the data where the law is ours And the servers hum all night.
 Bm _____ D _____ G _____
 Back the builders, keep the dreamers, Let the maple circuits run,
 D _____ A _____ D _____
 For a country isn't sovereign If the switch belongs to them.

[Verse 3]

They'll say "Careful don't be costly," They'll say "Cheaper just to rent,"
 G _____ D _____ A _____
 But the cheapest road to anywhere Is dearer when it's bent.
 D _____ G _____ D _____
 Every contract is a ballot, Every grant a line in the sand,
 N.C. _____ A _____ D _____
 Are we customers forever, Or the makers of this land?

[Final Chorus]

N.C.
I don't wanna be a branch plant folks. Don't wanna lease my name.
Don't wanna sell the northern lights And rent them back in shame
 D N.C. D N.C. G D
Give me compute, give me data, Give me sky that we command
 Bm A N.C. D
I don't wanna be the cherished fifty first, I wanna build this land.

[Outro]

Bm A Bm D A G
 So tune the fiddle to the future, Beat the drum and make it plain:
 D N.C. |D ///||
 A country that can build its own Need not be owned again. (ooh!)
 ||D ///|G /D /|Bm ///|D /A D |D ///|G /D /|D A/C# Bm /|Bm /A D ||
 (hey!)

D XX0232
 G 320003
 A X02220
 Bm X24432
 N.C. No Chord
 A/C# X42225